

Angier
TOWN OF CREPE MYRTLES

The Case Against Flock Cameras in Angier

By DeFlock Angier, a coalition of concerned Angier citizens, left, right, and center.



The Case Against Flock Cameras in Angier

- Summary for the Commission
- Mass Surveillance
- Data Sharing
- Data Security
- Abuse
- Mistakes
- Mistakes - The People Affected
- Constitutional violations
- Effectiveness
- Effectiveness in Angier
- Alternatives to Flock
- Why a Policy Won’t Work

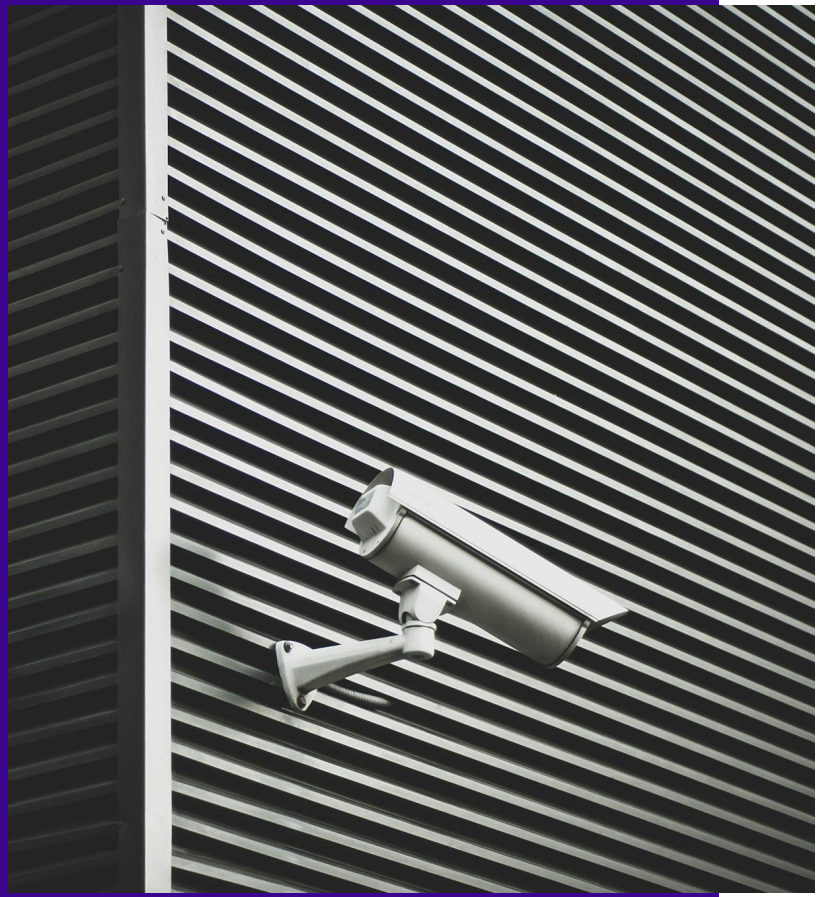


Mayor, Angier Commission

Thank you for taking the Flock camera issue seriously. We were disappointed that while the commission gave the police chief over an hour to speak about Flock cameras, **citizens were not permitted the same.**

This presentation **is what we would have delivered in front of the Commission.** It contains facts on Flock, Angier's use, and alternatives. We are missing some public data, which we have requested, so some are our estimates.

The short answer is that the **Flock cameras which were placed without your knowledge have solved only one serious Angier crime per year, violate citizens' rights, place the city in jeopardy of a lawsuit, and cannot, and should not, be addressed by policy alone.**

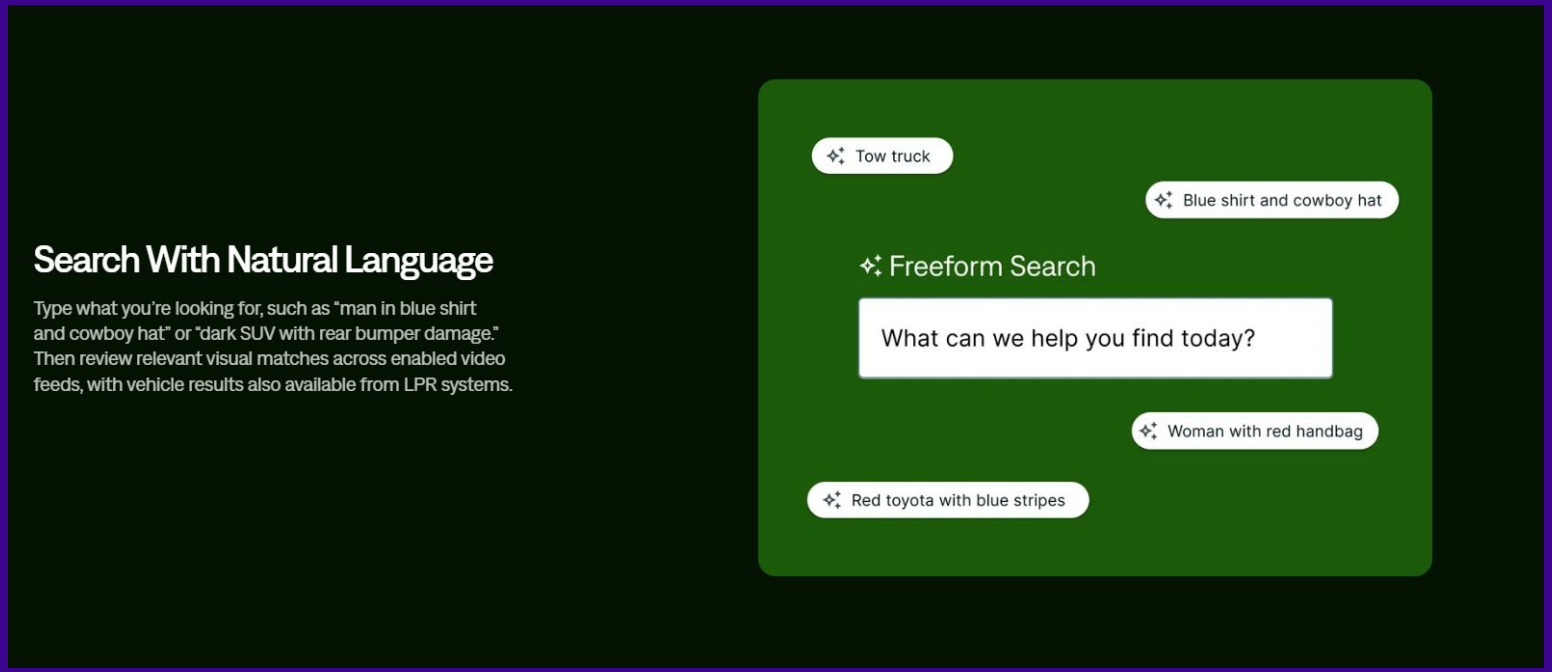


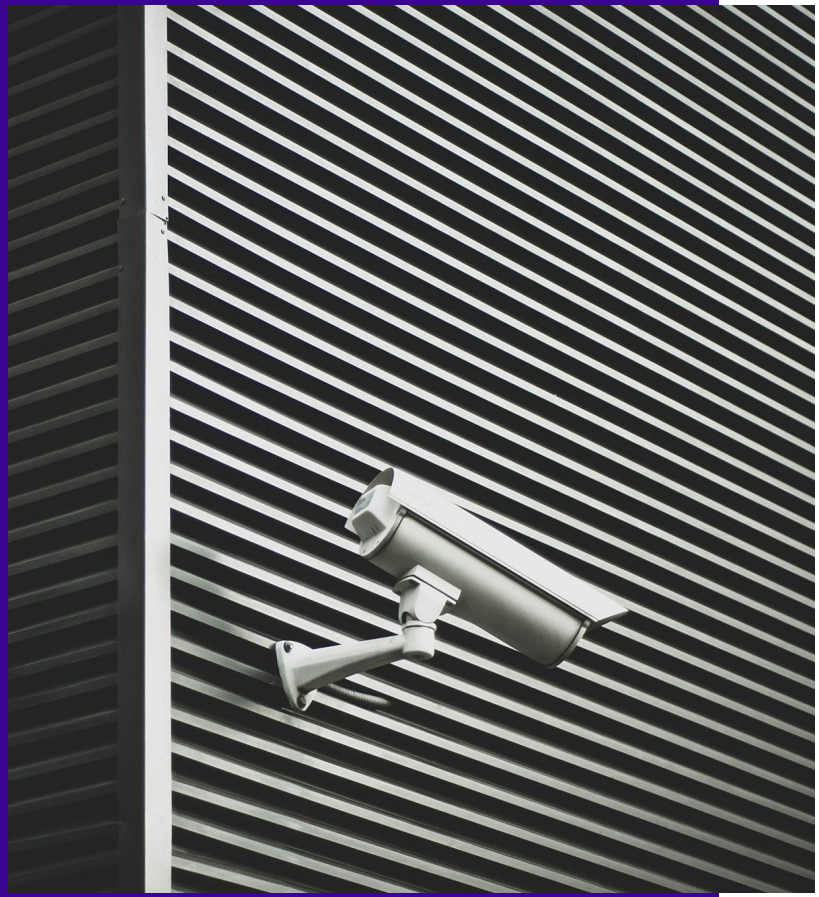
Mass Surveillance

- Flock Cameras are cameras. The software does the license plate reading. **This means they take images of cars, plates, people, bumper stickers, and more.** Flock Freeform, a product offered by Flock, offers this exact service on its website.
- According to similarly-sized cities, Angier's Flock Cameras take approximately 200,000 images per month. With 38 cases noted over two years with even a partial solve, most from out of town, that means that **out of every 100,000 images, 99,998 of them are pictures of innocent citizens' plates.**

Does Flock Only Capture a Plate?

- This image is from Flock Freeform, a search tool that can be used with flock cameras.





Mass Surveillance

- Unlike traditional cameras, thanks to Flock software, Flock cameras can establish patterns, such as where and when one goes to work, school, is home, or not home. **Angier PD confirms this with Case 24-00305, which shows a “daily routine was established” for a suspect.**



Data Sharing

- By default, Flock shares our data automatically with all customers across the country. **Angier's proposed policy limits it to agencies in the Tri-county area, which is still 35 agencies and nearly 3,000 officers**, i**ncluding one where an officer has already been fired for abuse.**
- We control our copy of the data. But once it is shared with Flock, or a local agency, we do not control those copies and they may be kept for as long as Flock or the agency chooses to do so. **See the policy on the next slide.**

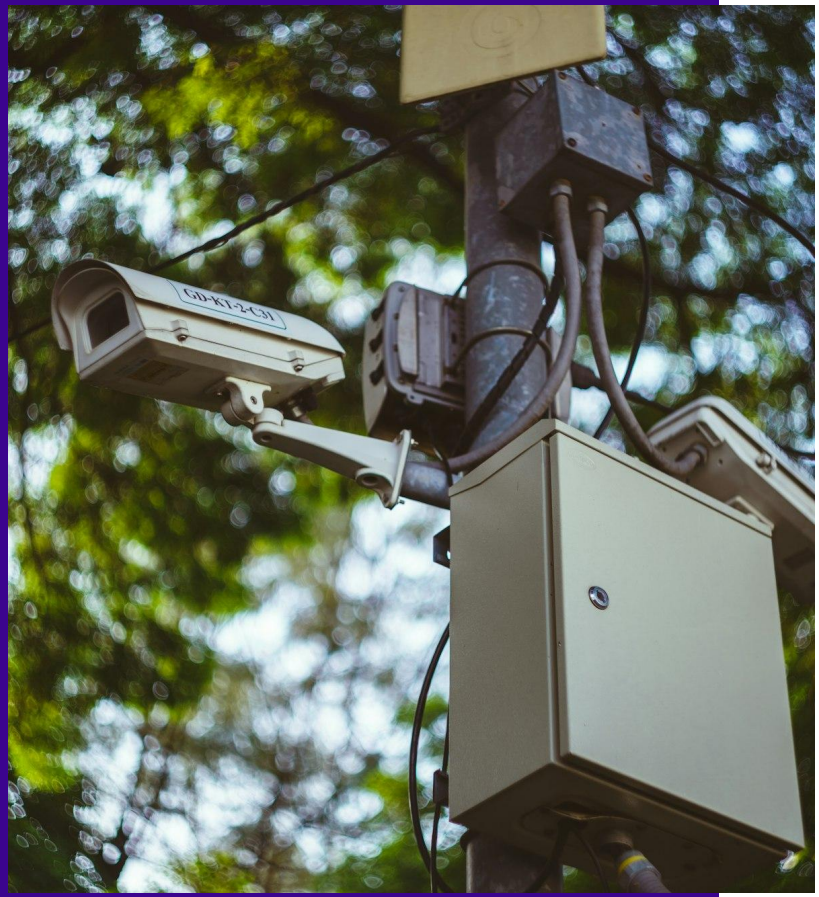
Do We Control Our Data?

License Plate Reader (LPR) Image Certification within Retention Period: For requests that are still within the retention period, customers can obtain a certification automatically through downloading either the LPR Image or the associated Investigative Summary within the Flock user interface. Both the images and summaries contain certifications that constitute self-authenticating Flock evidence for use at trial. For more information on downloading and exporting an Image or Investigative Summary, please see our Help Article.



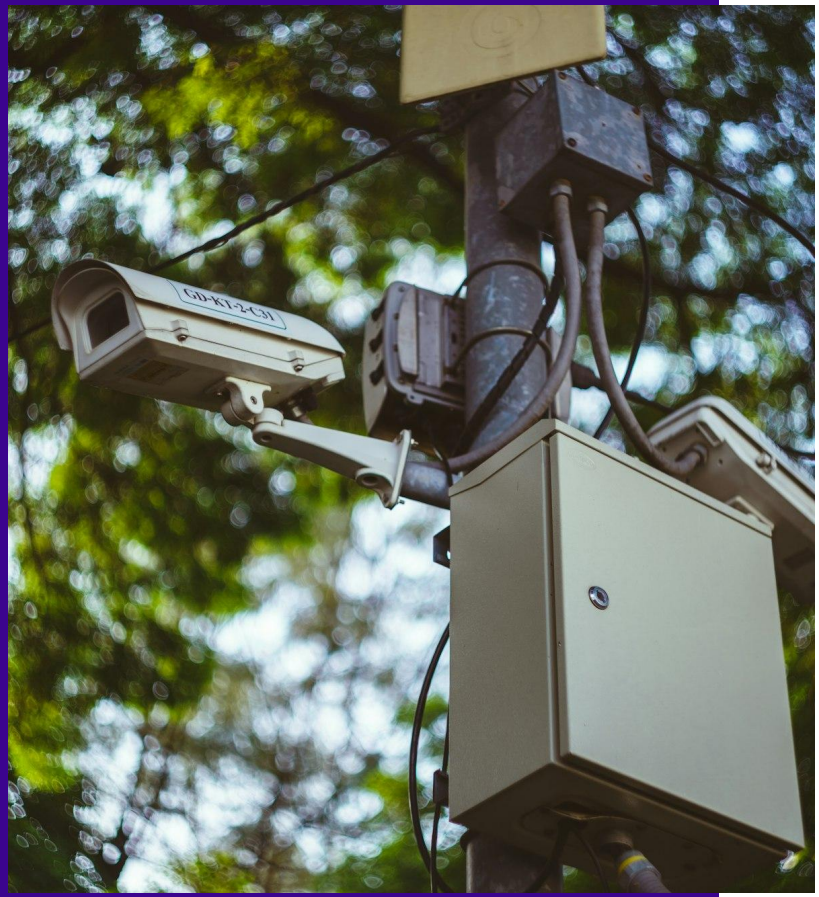
Data Sharing

- Flock has not been honest about data retention. A Flock representative offered to sell the city of Sheboygan, WI, 5 years of traffic and movement data - data they were unaware was being kept.
- Flock's contracts with Harnett County, NC and Marathon, WI indicated it may keep "deleted" footage subject to a court order. **Flock cannot keep deleted footage unless that footage has not been deleted from Flock's servers, demonstrating they have a separate copy of our data.**



Data Sharing

- We don’t own Flock data. Flock does. Flock confirmed to the Racine, WI, Sheriff’s department that **it was keeping their data for 5 years, and that, once aggregated, it ultimately owned the data**.
- Appalachian State found this out the hard way. “When an out-of-state department searches its plate against App State’s cameras and gets a hit, that record enters the searching agency’s system — **beyond the reach of North Carolina’s statute**.” - Wautagua Democrat, Sep. 4, 2026.



Data Sharing

- We cannot control the reasons other agencies search our data. **An agency can enter LOL as the case number**, as Harris County, TX deputies did, and we cannot stop it.
- Other tools are being developed on top of Flock cameras with greater capabilities. **VIDIZMO offers facial-recognition capabilities for Flock footage**. Nova promises to be able to link a plate to anyone tied to the vehicle next to instantly.



Data Sharing

- Flock is also very clear that it may use our data in different ways. From the **Harnett County Contract**:
- “§4.1 Customer hereby grants to Flock a limited, non-exclusive, royalty-free, irrevocable, **worldwide license to use the Customer Data**..”
- “§4.3 Customer hereby grants Flock a…right to **use and distribute such Anonymized Data….**”
- “§5.3 **Flock may access, use, and/or preserve**…the Footage…if Flock has a good faith belief…”



Data Security

- Flock cameras are dangerously insecure. Since flock cameras store all images on the device, **someone who gained access to a Flock camera could have access to all the images it collects, or live footage.** Hackers have taken control of a Flock camera in under 30 seconds by pressing buttons on the back of the camera.
- Hackers have also physically accessed images on flock cameras. One hacking collective gathered 1.6 million images of 50,000 cars from a single flock camera.



Data Security

- Flock passwords have been sold on Russian websites by hackers, as shown by OR Sen. Wyden. **At least 30 Agency passwords were leaked on Russian websites last year** which would allow unauthorized users to login to their Flock systems.
- Flock itself has also been hacked. In November 2025, a leaked map key revealed 300,000 Flock devices. **Flock didn't tell police departments about it until 2026.**
- The National Institute of Standards and Technology, a government agency, **has a list of 15 security vulnerabilities**, including two critical ones, not listed as resolved by Flock Safety.



Camera Abuse

- The Institute for Justice tracks Flock camera abuses by law enforcement agencies and officers. **There have been 261 non-error instances of abuse of Flock since 2024**, and over 50 officers have been accused of abusing access to Flock systems since, including a Harnett County detective.
- The most common abuses are stalking romantic love interests and stalking other police officers. **85 of the over 200 instances of abuse were for stalking.**



Camera Abuse

- **At the current abuse rate of 1 in 2,210 officers, Angier is almost guaranteed to have an abuse case** given the automatic data sharing access to the currently planned departments (3,000 officers total).
- Most of these abuses happened inside police departments that already had policies in place. State law requires departments to have a policy for Flock implementation before use.



Mistakes

- Flock cameras have a notoriously high error rate. O**ne study from the Roseville, CA police department found that Flock Cameras successfully read plates only 29% of the time,** often mistaking “9” for “8” and “3” for “2”. A data review by the CA Attorney General of Los Angeles Police Department ALPR systems found a 32% error rate over 3 months.
- **Flock itself admits that the error rate for its cameras is about 7%.**
- Innocent drivers nationally have been stopped at gunpoint or jailed at least 27 times by bad license plate reads, AI error, and alerts.



Mistakes

- This means, of the 38 cases Flock is listed as a part of in the Chief's log list, i**t is very likely that between 3 and 12 were innocent individuals**, subject to arrest, detention, and law enforcement action.



Mistakes - The Victims

- In **York County, SC**, Iraq War veteran Steven Melvin spent five minutes on his knees at gunpoint when a Flock camera misread his plate.
- In Sherwood, AR, a Flock camera identified a black SUV as stolen, mistaking an X in the plate for a Y. **The family was held at gunpoint with their six-week old infant in the back.**



Mistakes - The Victims

- Lindsey Isaacs, 23, of Volusia County, FL, **spent 13 days in jail on homicide charges** after a Flock camera wrongly identified her vehicle based on a partial plate. She was released when her attorney dug through the evidence.
- Brandon Upchurch, from Toledo, OH, was mauled by a police K-9 and jailed after a Flock camera misread a 7 on his plate as a 2. **Charges were dropped, and he settled with the city for $35,000.**



Constitutional Violations

- In *United States v. Knotts*, the Supreme Court held that a citizen does not have a reasonable expectation of privacy in public. But it ruled that dragnet surveillance would be resolved later.
- As Flock cameras are not just cameras, but a software that can track an individual vehicle's location, **Flock cameras are most similar to cell-phone location tracking.**



Constitutional Violations

- In *United States v. Jones*, the Supreme Court ruled that long-term location tracking was a violation of privacy, even on public roads. In *Chatrie v. United States*, the Supreme Court ruled that getting a phone's google location history was a search, and required a warrant. In *Carpenter v. United States*, the Court put it plainly "A person does not surrender all Fourth Amendment protection by venturing into the public sphere".
- This means the likely legal result is that Flock searches are a search, and will require a warrant.



Constitutional Violations

- The conversation up until today has been if, in theory, Flock cameras were declared unconstitutional. However, cities have already been sued numerous times for Flock mistakes. **Most ALPR-specific cases are still open, but those that have closed have had an average payout of $50,000 to the victims.**



Constitutional Violations

- In Charlotte, NC, and Fayetteville, NC, police in both cities mistakenly linked Jacqueline McNeil to a shooting via ALPR cameras. **Both cities combined paid out $70,000.**
- In Detroit, MI, a mother was misidentified as a suspect via ALPR camera by Detroit Police. **Detroit paid her $30,000.**
- In Aurora, CO, police held a mother and her daughters at gunpoint after an ALPR camera read her plate correctly but misidentified the state. **Aurora, CO paid her $1.9 million.**



Effectiveness

- There is no nationwide study that has shown that Flock cameras, compared to other police tools and resources, lead to a reduction in overall crime. **Most studies have found what Lum, et. al did, which was that ALPRs had “no discernable differences in the levels of crime”.**



Effectiveness

- This is backed up by Angier's Flock logs. Out of roughly 200,000 images taken per month, Flock has been a tool used in only 38 cases, of which only 21 were in Angier.
- **The only crime Flock cameras have been reported as effective in solving is motor vehicle theft.** One disputed study showed an 11% reduction. **Angier has around 5 total motor vehicle thefts per year.**



Effectiveness in Angier

- Flock cameras were used in 38 out of the roughly 1,000+ cases Angier police filed over two total years.
- **Out of the 38 cases, only 21 were crimes committed in Angier.**
- Out of the 21, only 11 led to an arrest or charges.
- **Out of those 11, only 6 were serious.**
- Out of the 6 serious crimes in Angier, only 3 were solved by any Flock camera and **only 2 were solved by Angier Flock Cameras in two years.**
- Angier Flock cameras have all of the aforementioned issues, and only solve 1 serious crime in Angier per year. **They have costed the taxpayers of the town of Angier an estimated $60,000-$70,000. What else could that money be put towards?**



Alternatives to Flock

- The following are **data-backed alternatives to Flock** cameras that protect citizen rights, reduce crime, and drive citizen trust.
- **Hire an additional part-time officer or investigator.** Angier PD has few enough investigators that every police officer is being given access to the Flock system. Instead of paying funds for a surveillance camera on all citizens, use the funding to hire additional support.
- **Streetlights** - Streetlights have the largest effect on crime, reducing nighttime crimes in newly or better-lit areas by 36%.
- **Cleaning up vacant lots** - This has been shown to reduce crime by 10-20% in Philadelphia.
- **Use the funds for economic growth** - Another driver of crime reductions and beneficial for the city at large.



Why A Policy Won't Work

- The core issue is that Angier's Flock cameras are a mass surveillance system of cameras that track Angier citizens', their traffic patterns, and daily lives. Out of 200,000 pictures taken each month, less than one can plausibly be of a suspect. **A policy will just ensure it, it will not change it.**
- Policies did not stop any of the aforementioned officers from abusing Flock's power.
- Angier cannot afford Flock. The cameras will come back to bite us. **It's not a question of if, but when. No policy will protect the town from the fallout when that comes.**